PIA3123
THEORIES of DEVELOPMENT

WEEK 1 INTRODUCTION

BY FRANCESCA CHIU

Who am I?

Francesca Chiu

f.chiu@cityu.edu.hk (no Canvas message)

Room 5331, Li Dak Sum Yip Yio Chin Academic Building (AC2)

(By appointment only)

Today's lecture

1. What are we studying here?
2. Course outline
3. Assessment
4. What is development?



What comes to mind when you hear the word ‘development’?

Scan the QR code to join the word cloud!

What are we studying here?

- Our focus is not on providing a step-by-step guide or studying every development theories
- We are here instead asking what constitutes development, and how we should understand development issues and their politics



Course Outline

Week	Title
1	Introduction to International Development
2	The Making of Underdevelopment: Modernization and Dependency
3	The Market and the State: Neoliberalism and Developmental State
4	The Alternatives: Human Development and Sustainable Development
5	Agents of Development
6	Quiz 1
7	Politics of Aid
8	Gender and Development
9	Post-development
10	Reading Week
11	AI and the Future of International Development
12	Documentary Screening
13	Quiz 2

Assessment

Format	Weight	Date
1. Participation	20%	Throughout
2. Quiz 1	30%	October 9, 2026
3. Documentary Analysis and Reflection	20%	November 20, 2026
4. Quiz 2	30%	November 27, 2026

Participation

- Your participation will be evaluated from Weeks 2 to 13. The class participation grade will be evaluated based on two components:

a. participation in lecture discussions

b. the calibre of feedback provided to fellow peers throughout the term.

Documentary Analysis and Reflection

We will have a documentary screening in Week 12.

You will watch the documentary in class and complete an individual written analysis and reflection during the lecture.

The reflection will require students to identify key development issues presented in the documentary, apply relevant theories and concepts covered in the course, and critically reflect on the documentary's perspectives and implications.

Quizzes

We will have an in-class quiz during Week 6's and Week 13's lecture

Quiz 1 will cover the concepts and materials in Weeks 2 to 5.

Quiz 2 will cover the whole course.

The quizzes will consist of short essay-style questions.

They are closed-book quizzes.

Study Strategies

The quiz is designed to assess your understanding of the main concepts and debates covered in the course, rather than your ability to memorize every single detail from the readings.

As you prepare, focus on the key concepts, arguments, and differences between the theories we have studied. You should be able to explain the main ideas in your own words and recognize how different theories would approach a development issue.

A useful way to study is to create a comparison table.

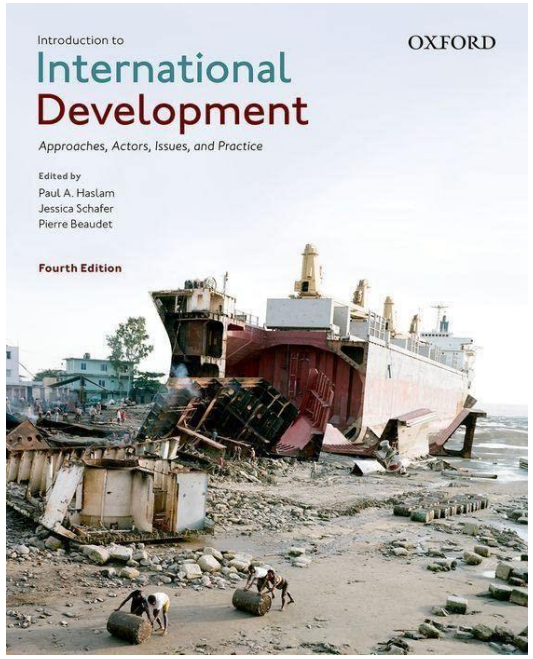
Try to apply theories to policies and real world examples. And do not assume one policy=one theory.

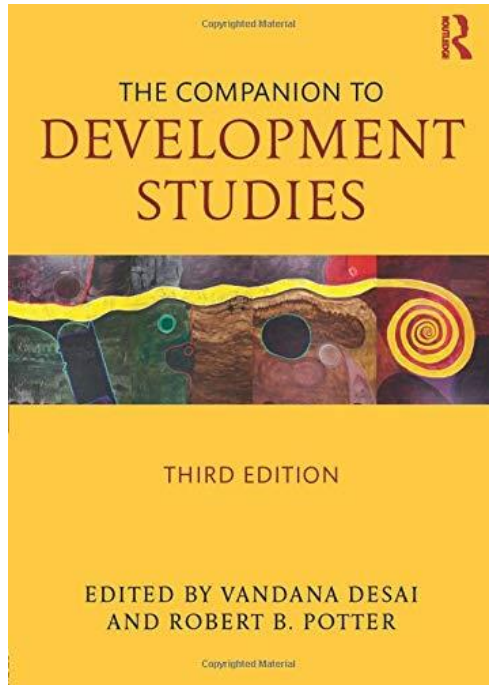
Try not to leave all your studying until the day before the quiz. Study regularly.

(Read the course outline for more details)

A Special Note on Using AI Tools

- You are not allowed to use AI tools to generate an essay and submit it as your work. Engaging in academic tasks necessitates submitting work that is genuinely your own. Using AI in an assessment includes, but is not limited to:
- a. Using AI tools for research purposes
- b. Incorporating ideas generated by AI
- c. Employing AI translation tools
- Using AI to generate an essay is not deemed as your authentic original work. Your essays undergo Turnitin checks to detect AI-generated text. Employing AI tools to write your essays constitutes a form of plagiarism and will lead to zero marks and possible disciplinary actions.





Reading and Preparation

- Two recommended textbooks
- Essential and supplementary reading in book chapters and journals
- All the required readings will be accessible online through the CityU library. In cases where certain books do not have an available e-book option in the CityU library, I will upload the designated sections from those books on Canvas.

Any questions?

What is development studies?

1. Who needs development?





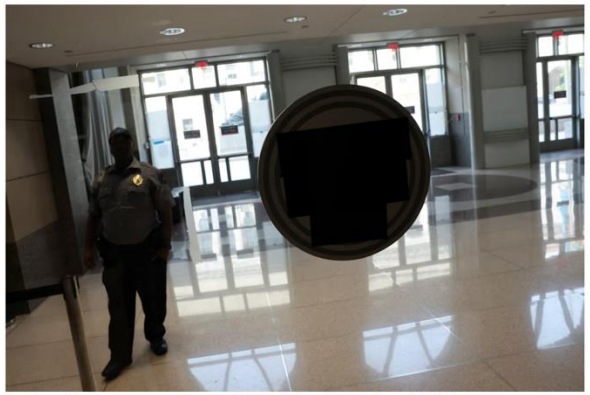




As USAID stops foreign aid, Rubio says future US assistance will be limited

By **Humeyra Pamuk**

July 2, 2025 1:51 AM GMT+8 · Updated July 2, 2025



A security guard is stationed in the former offices of the U.S. Agency for International Development (USAID), where black tape covers the signage on the windows, in the Ronald Reagan Building and International Trade Center in Washington, D.C., U.S., April 24, 2025. REUTERS/Jonathan Ernst/File Photo Purchase Licensing Rights

What is development?

2. How should development happen?



Vote

It's all about national economic growth!

Development is about equality!

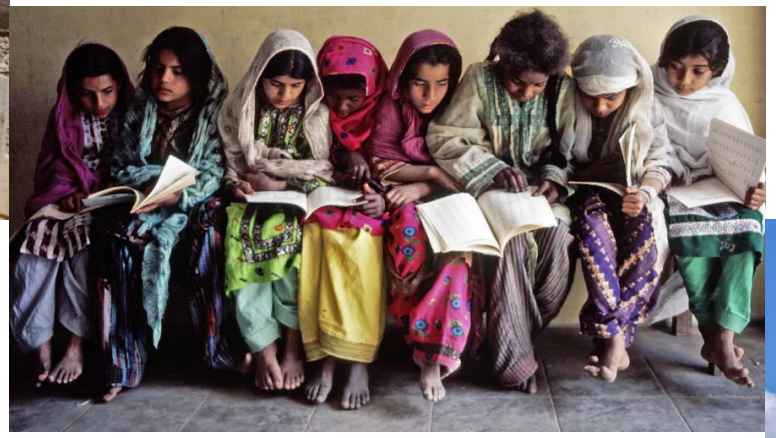
But how about freedoms and human rights?

We must consider sustainability!

What is development?

3. Why is development important?







Paradigms	Who needs development?	How should it happen?	What is the importance?
Modernisation			
Dependency			
Neo-liberalism			
Developmental State			
Human development			
Sustainable development			
Post-development			

Course Outline

Week	Title
1	Introduction to International Development
2	The Making of Underdevelopment: Modernization and Dependency
3	The Market and the State: Neoliberalism and Developmental State
4	The Alternatives: Human Development and Sustainable Development
5	Agents of Development
6	Quiz 1
7	Politics of Aid
8	Gender and Development
9	Post-development
10	Reading Week
11	AI and the Future of International Development
12	Documentary Screening
13	Quiz 2



What Are *Your* Questions About International Development?

What topics about development studies affect your life or interest you?

Take 2 minutes to write down one question you have about international development.

Share your question with a partner or the class if you feel comfortable.

Conclusion

- On the one hand, identifying a population as in need of development assumes that development exists elsewhere and that there is some understanding of what caused that condition.
- On the other hand, by identifying social faults and inequalities and viewing them as flaws that can be corrected, the concept of what it means to be developed can be altered.

Conclusion

- Development studies encompass a combination of theories or discourses, as well as practices and policies (Kothari, 2019).
- In your opinion, how should we conceptualize development, and what political actions or interventions does this perspective imply?

Next Week

Week 2 Modernization and Dependency

Essential Readings

Frank, A.G. 2010. 'The Development of Underdevelopment'. In *Theory and Methodology of World Development : The Writings of Andre Gunder Frank*, edited by S. Chew and P. Lauderdale, 7–18. New York: Palgrave Macmillan.

Rostow, W.W. 1990a. 'Introduction'. In *The Stages of Economic Growth: A Non-Communist Manifesto*, 1–3. New York: Cambridge University Press.

Rostow, W.W. 1990b. 'The Five Stages of Growth- A Summary'. In *The Stages of Economic Growth: A Non-Communist Manifesto*, 4–16. New York: Cambridge University Press.

Supplementary Readings

Kvangraven, I.H. 2021. 'Beyond the Stereotype: Restating the Relevance of the Dependency Research Programme'. *Development and Change* 52 (1): 76–112.